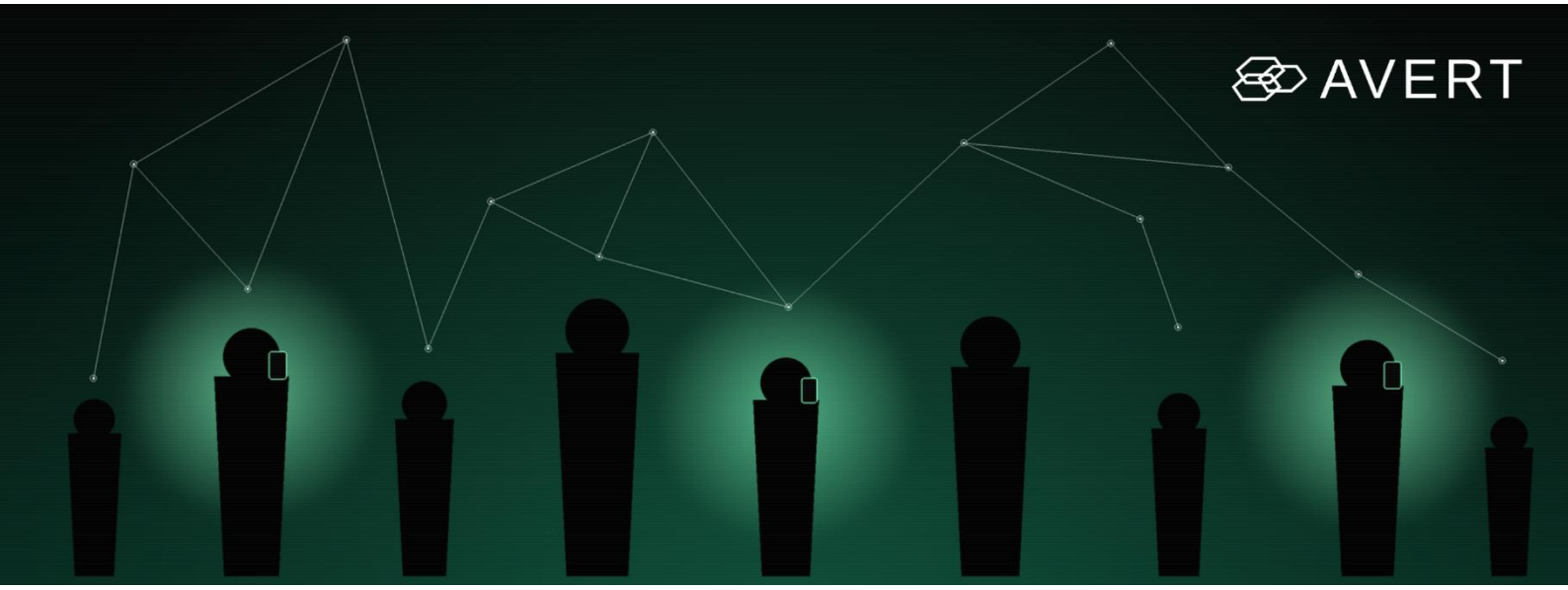
AVERT
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AVERT Research Network
NATIONAL RESEARCH SYMPOSIUM 2026

YOUTH AND EXTREMISM: THRESHOLDS, INTERVENTIONS, CONNECTIONS

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SYMPOSIUM VENUE



Clifton's Sydney – Spring Street
Level 3, 10 Spring Street
Sydney NSW 2000
02 9250 0999

Getting there:

- The closest train stations are Wynyard Station (2 min walk) and Martin Place Station (5 min walk)
- The closest bus stops are Carrington St Bus Interchange (4 min walk), Spring St (0 min walk) or Pitt St Australia Square (1 min walk)
- The closest tram stop is George St (2 min walk)
- Car parking is available at Wilson Parking, 20 Bond St (2 min walk) or Wilson Parking, 1 O'Connell St (2 min walk)
- The closest accommodation options are Paradox Sydney (1 min walk), The Fullerton Hotel Sydney (5 min walk), Sydney Harbour Marriott Circular Quay (3 min walk) or Sofitel Sydney Wentworth (4 min walk)
- Clifton's Sydney Spring Street is approx. 13km from Sydney Airport, which takes 20 mins on the Airport Train from Wynyard Station or 20-55 min driving (dependent on traffic)

PROGRAMME AT A GLANCE

Day 1 – Thursday 26 November 2026		*(All dates and times AEDT)*
8:00 – 8:30	**Arrival and Registration**	
8:30 – 10:00	**Plenary Session**	
8:30 – 8:40	**Welcome & Acknowledgment of Country, Housekeeping** *Professor Michele Grossman AM, Deakin University*	
8:40 – 9:00	**Opening Remarks** *Dr Kelly Mischel, Department of Justice and Community Safety, Victoria* *Sophie Murray-Farrell, NSW Premier's Department* **Opening Remarks** *Professor Michele Grossman AM, Deakin University*	
9:00 – 10:00	**The Canadian Journey to PVE: From Specialised Teams to an Integrated Practitioner-Research-Policy Approach** *Professor Ghayda Hassan, Université du Québec à Montréal (UQÀM) / CPN-PREV* **Chair:** *Professor Michele Grossman AM, Deakin University*	
10:00 – 10:25	**Morning Tea**	
10:25 – 10:30	**Participants to move to next session**	
10:30 – 11:45	**Session 1A – Paper Presentation – There's an Algorithm for That: Young People's Digital Network Dynamics**	**Session 1B – Paper Presentation – A Family Affair? Protections, Vulnerabilities and CVE Programming**
	Chair: *Dr Callum Jones, Deakin University* **It's Not Just Exposure: Identifying Young People's Network Positions and Influence in Large-Scale Online Hate Networks** *Dr Andrea Giovannetti, Australian Catholic University* **When Content Finds You: Recommender Algorithms, Youth Agency and the Thresholds of Online Extremism** *Stephen Kei, Young Diplomats Society (YDS)* **From Players to Partners: How Young Gamers Are Building Safer Online Gaming Communities in Southeast Asia** *Sidonie Roberts, UNOCT* *Olivia Rylah, Department of Home Affairs*	**Chair:** *Associate Professor Keiran Hardy, Griffith University* **Beyond Risk: The Contribution of Social Work and Family Partnerships in Countering Youth Extremism** *Dr Tony Stanley, Oranga Tamariki* **Developmental pathways away from extremism: Family-based intervention in youth CVE practice** *Sarah Stevenson, Youth Justice NSW* **Looking Beyond Behaviour: Recognising Coercive and Relational Vulnerability in Violent Extremism Prevention** *Emma Gerhardy, Adelaide University / Department of Human Services*
11:45 – 11:50	**Participants to move to next session**	
11:50 – 13:05	**Session 2A – Paper Presentation – Thinking, Being, Doing: Connecting Ideologies, Identities and Actions**	**Session 2B – Panel – International Comparative Approaches to Youth and Online Radicalisation**
	Chair: *Dr Alexandra Phelan, Monash University* **From Online Milieus to Exemplary Violence: Youth, Social Identity, and Ideological Inheritance in Right-Wing Lone-Actor Manifestos** *Dr Dean Bohlinger-Smith, University of St Andrews* **Beyond Ideology: Addressing Belonging, Identity and Significance in Youth CVE**	**Chair:** *Alexander Goldie, Department of Home Affairs* *Dr Angus Lindsay, Department of Prime Minister and Cabinet NZ* *Vanessa Sima, Public Safety Canada* *Élise van Pul, Ministry of Justice and Security, the Netherlands*

	Intervention *Joshua G, Victoria Police* **Rebirth Through Violence: M/NVE, Significance and the Protean Self** *Dr Gerard Gill, Independent*	*Scott Storrie, Home Office, United Kingdom* *Matin Tirmizi, German Federal Ministry of the Interior (BMI)*
13:05 – 13:55	**Lunch**	
13:55 – 14:00	**Participants to move to next session**	
14:00 – 15:00	**Session 3A – Panel – How the Voices of Victims Can Counter Terrorism and Extremism through Cultivating Empathy in At-risk Youth**	**Session 3B – Workshop – Designing Prevention for Intersecting Digital Harms: Violent extremism, technology-facilitated gender-based violence and child safety online**
	Chair: *Caroline O'Hare APM, VOTA Board* *Dr David Gawel, VOTA* *Louisa Hope, VOTA*	**Moderators:** *Dr Yasmin Chilmeran and Alex Bradbrook, Christchurch Call Foundation*
15:00 – 15:05	**Participants to move to next session**	
15:05 – 16:05	**Session 4A – Panel – From Online Harm to Operational Response: Combatting Sadistic Online Exploitation in Practice Across Australia and New Zealand**	**Session 4B – Roundtable – Videogaming and Extremism 101**
	Chair: *Charlotte Fleming, Department of Human Services South Australia* *Glenn Williams, Department of Internal Affairs' Digital Violent Extremism Team, NZ* *Kris Wilson, AFP Operation Pompilid* *Tom Stewart, Department of Human Services South Australia*	**Chair:** *Associate Professor Helen Young, Deakin University* *I. Baik (Youth Worker and Gamer)* *M. Pinder (Parent, Gamer and Researcher)* *S. Settineri-Weisz (Gamer)*
16:05 – 16:30	**Afternoon Tea**	
16:30 – 16:35	**Participants to move to next session**	
16:35 – 17:50	**Session 5A – Paper Presentation – Tools and Tensions in Understanding and Assessing VE Risks**	**Session 5B – Paper Presentation – Extreme Behaviours: Moving In and Out of Nihilistic Violence Ecosystems**
	Chair: *Professor Ghayda Hassan, Université du Québec à Montréal (UQÀM) / CPN-PREV* **Risk and Protective Factors Associated with Youth Radicalisation: An Umbrella Review of Systematic Reviews and Meta-Analyses** *Lujia Pei, University College London* **Who Should We Be Worried About? Age, Ideology and the Lethality Paradox in Violent Extremism** *Associate Professor Josh Roose, Deakin University / The Dor Foundation* **Violent Extremism in Youth: Introducing the Assessment of Risk for Extremist Violence in Adolescents–Consultation Version (AREVA-CV)** *Professor Natalie Pyszora, WA Department of Health / Victoria University / University of Western Australia &*	**Chair:** *Professor Michele Grossman AM, Deakin University* **A Strategic Framework for Identifying, Preventing and Offramping Nihilistic Violence** *Hannah Rose, Institute for Strategic Dialogue* **Remotely Coerced Violence and the Hybridization of Threats** *Dr Angus Lindsay, Department of Prime Minister and Cabinet, NZ* **Formulating Pathways to Engagement with The Com** *Dr Caitlin Clemmow, University College London*

	Caroline Logan, University College London	
17:50 – 17:55	**Participants to move to next session**	
17:55 – 18:05	**Closing Remarks –** *Professor Michele Grossman AM, Deakin University*	
Day 1 – Close		
18:15 – 20:30	**Networking Reception**	

Day 2 – Friday 27 November 2026		*(All dates and times AEDT)*
8:00 – 8:30	**Arrival and Registration**	
8:30 – 9:35	**Plenary Session**	
8:30 – 8:35	**Welcome to Day 2**	
8:35 – 9:35	**Perspectives from the Counter-Terrorism Coordinator** *Brendan Dowling, Department of Home Affairs* **Chair:** *Professor Julian Droogan, Macquarie University*	
9:35 – 10:05	**Morning Tea**	
10:05 – 10:10	**Participants to move to next session**	
10:10 – 11:10	**Session 6A – Panel – By the Time We Noticed: Assessment Timing in Youth VE**	**Session 6B – Panel – Rethinking Radicalisation: Alternative Perspectives on Youth Experiences of Extremism**
	Chair: *Professor Debra Smith, Victoria University* *Professor Natalie Pyszora, WA Department of Health / Victoria University / University of Western Australia* *Associate Professor Muhammad Iqbal, Victoria University* *Dr Chris Winter, Victoria University*	**Chair:** *Dr Monty Badami, Habitus* *Dr James Mortensen, Australian National University* *Pascale Taplin, Australian National University* *Kosta Lucas, University of Notre Dame*
11:10 – 11:15	**Participants to move to next session**	
11:15 – 12:15	**Session 7A – Panel – Safeguarding Victoria Online: Australia's First Redirect–Prebunking Model for Preventing Online Violence**	**Session 7B – Paper Presentation – Youth Engagement with Online Extremist Content: Transnational Perspectives**
	Chair: *Dr Kelly Mischel, Department of Justice and Community Safety, Victoria* *Hemei Fong, Department of Justice and Community Safety, Victoria* *Theresa Rajah, Moonshot* *Dr Callum Jones, Deakin University*	**Chair:** *Associate Professor Muhammad Iqbal, Victoria University* **'Don't Be a Beta': Digitally-Mediated Misogyny, Social Media and the Normalisation of the Manosphere in Australian Schools** *Dr Alexandra Phelan, Monash University* **Islamic State of Khorasan in the West: Online Youth Engagement Patterns and Recruitment Pathways** *Saif Tahir, Victoria University of Wellington*
12:15 – 13:15	**Lunch**	
13:15 – 13:20	**Participants to move to next session**	
13:20 – 14:20	**Session 8A – Roundtable – Key Learnings from the Diversions Approach: How We Can Improve Online-offline Referral Mechanisms**	**Session 8B – Roundtable – Gender and Age-Responsive Rehabilitation and Reintegration of ISIS Returnees: Research and Practitioner Perspectives**
	Chair: *Adele Westerhuis, Violence Prevention Network* *Jodie Wrigley, SenateSHJ*	**Chair:** *Dr Yasmin Chilmeran, Christchurch Call Foundation* *Peta Lowe, Phronesis Consulting and Training*

	Dr Angus Lindsay, Department of Prime Minister and Cabinet NZ *Anh Rivera, Yokoten Consultancy*	*Dr Helen Stenger, Monash University*
14:20 – 14:50	**Afternoon Tea**	
14:50 – 14:55	**Participants to move to next session**	
14:55 – 16:10	**Session 9A – Paper Presentation – Doing It For Themselves: Youth Networks, Influences and Responses**	**Session 9B – Paper Presentation – Boots on the Ground: Lessons and Insights from International Practice-led P/CVE Analysis and Programming**
	Chair: *Dr Julian Junk, Leibniz Peace Research Institute Frankfurt (PRIF)* **What Is to Be Done? Centring the Perspectives of Young Australians in Responding to Controversial or Violent Online Content** *Dr Ben Adams, Adelaide University* **The Sisterhood of Transition: Gendered Pathways into Violent Extremism among Female University Students in Indonesia** *Dr Nuri Veronika, University of Melbourne* **Antifeminism and Toxic Masculinity Online Manifestations and Responses in Schools** *Dr Daniela Pisoiu, SCENOR*	**Chair:** *Associate Professor Natalie Davis, Deakin University* **Exploring the Need for Increased Neurodiversity Expertise within Counter-terrorism Teams** *Dr Abigail Love, Victoria Police* *Luke F, Victoria Police* **Results from a German Nationwide Survey on Good Practices in Working with Juveniles in CVE Programs** *Sinja Wernz, State Bureau of Investigation Baden-Wuerttemberg (LKA)* **Unmet Mental Health Needs in Youth: Qualitative and Quantitative Analysis of Recent UK P/CVE Data** *Dr Amber Seaward, University College London*
16:10 – 16:15	**Participants to move to next session**	
16:15 – 16:35	**Closing Remarks** *Associate Professor Keiran Hardy, Griffith University*	
Day 2 – Close		